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Act No. 127 (S.232). An act relating to public libraries and the Department of Libraries

Subjects: Education; municipal government; libraries, history, and information technology; bonding; Department of Libraries; Vermont Libraries Day; Universal Afterschool and Summer Special Fund; early education grants; State Librarian duties; improvements for public libraries

This act designates the third Monday in the month of October as “Vermont Libraries Day.” This act also amends the statute governing the Universal Afterschool and Summer Special Fund to authorize the Agency of Education to allocate a portion of program funds to the Department of Libraries for subgrants to public libraries; require the Agency of Education to create a simple application and reporting process for small, community-based organizations; add the State Librarian as a member of the advisory committee that supports the Secretary of Education with administration of funds; and require the advisory committee to solicit public input on an annual basis concerning grant programs and procedures related to administration of the Special Fund. This act also amends 16 V.S.A. § 4014 to expressly include public libraries as eligible recipients of funds for voluntary early education programs. This act also amends the duties of the Department of Libraries to incorporate references to both digital and physical collections of library materials and to modernize references to interlibrary loans. This act also amends 22 V.S.A. § 143 to add language that limits how that section may be construed with respect to public libraries that are privately established or incorporated. This act also amends 24 V.S.A. § 1752a to expressly reference capital improvements for public libraries as an eligible basis for the issuance of a municipal bond. Finally, this act also repeals the Audio-Visual Revolving Fund.

Effective Date: July 1, 2026